



Sea sparkle

As night falls, the seashore lights up. Everywhere you look, the waves glitter and glow. This amazing effect is created by billions upon billions of living things – sea sparkles! Sea sparkles are a type of life form called a dinoflagellate (di-no-fla-gell-ate), which live in water and are only one cell big. Each is so small that it could sit on a pinhead. To move through the water, it lashes a long tail from side to side, like a whip.

Sea sparkles glow when they are touched. This may scare away hungry predators, such as shrimp-like copepods. The movement of waves lapping on the shore is enough to make a whole beach shine blue.